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SLOT : B

FUNDAMENTALS OF TEAM BUILDING AND LEADERSHIP

DIGITAL ASSIGNMENT – 1

"Using real or hypothetical team scenarios, explain how Thomas-Kilmann Conflict Mode Instrument (TKI) and its five conflict-handling styles can impact team dynamics, effectiveness, and outcome"

The Thomas-Kilmann conflict Mode Instrument outlines five conflict-handling styles based on two dimensions:

- **Assertiveness**-the degree to which a person tries to satisfy their own concerns.
- **Cooperativeness**-the degree to which a person tries to satisfy the other person's concerns.

These styles are:

1. Competing
2. Collaborating
3. Compromising
4. Avoiding
5. Accommodating

1. Competing

- High Assertiveness
- Low Cooperativeness

Individuals using this style prioritize their own needs and goals above others. It is assertive and uncooperative, meaning the person aims to "win" the conflict even if it comes at the cost of relationships or team harmony.

Scenario :

In a software development team, the lead developer insists on using a programming language they prefer, ignoring other team members' suggestions.

Impact :

- **Team Dynamics:** May create tension and reduce psychological safety.
- **Effectiveness:** Can be efficient for quick decision-making in emergencies but may suppress creativity.
- **Outcome:** Results in a fast decision but risks demotivating others and missing better ideas.

2. Collaborating

- High Assertiveness
- High Cooperativeness

Collaborating is the most constructive style in the TKI model. It involves both assertiveness and cooperativeness, meaning the individual seeks to satisfy both their own needs and those of others. This style is centered around open dialogue, mutual respect, and

creative problem-solving. It is most effective in complex situations where multiple perspectives can lead to better solutions.

Scenario :

In a marketing team, two members have different campaign ideas. They brainstorm together, integrate the best parts of both strategies, and produce a hybrid plan.

Impact:

- **Team Dynamics:** Builds trust, encourages open communication, and mutual respect.
- **Effectiveness:** Highly effective for complex problems that require multiple perspectives.
- **Outcome:** Results in innovative solutions with strong team buy-in.

3. Compromising

- Moderate Assertiveness
- Moderate Cooperativeness

The compromising style involves finding a middle ground where both parties give up something to resolve the conflict. It reflects a balance between assertiveness and cooperativeness, aiming for a solution that is acceptable to all, but not necessarily optimal. This style is particularly useful when time is limited or when parties have equal power.

Scenario:

In a project team, two departments have conflicting priorities. They agree to split resources 50/50 to meet halfway.

Impact:

- **Team Dynamics:** Maintains balance, but may leave some team members only partially satisfied.
- **Effectiveness:** Useful when time is limited, but may not address root causes.
- **Outcome:** Quick resolution, though sometimes suboptimal for long-term goals.

4. Avoiding

- Low Assertiveness
- Low Cooperativeness

Avoiding is a conflict-handling style where individuals choose not to engage with the conflict at all. It involves low assertiveness and low cooperativeness, meaning the individual neither pursues their own interests nor helps resolve others' concerns. This style may be used when the issue is trivial, when the individual feels emotionally overwhelmed, or when they believe that addressing the issue is not worth the effort.

Scenario:

During a team meeting, two employees disagree on task distribution. The manager changes the subject and avoids addressing the conflict.

Impact:

- **Team Dynamics:** Unresolved tension can build, harming collaboration.
- **Effectiveness:** May be appropriate for minor issues or when emotions run high.
- **Outcome:** Delays resolution, potentially worsening the situation if the conflict resurfaces.

5. Accommodating

- Low Assertiveness
- High Cooperativeness

Accommodating is a style in which an individual puts others' needs above their own, often yielding or giving in to preserve harmony. It is unassertive but highly cooperative. This approach is useful when the issue matters more to the other party, or when maintaining the relationship is more important than the outcome.

Scenario:

A junior designer disagrees with a decision but stays silent to maintain harmony.

Impact:

- **Team Dynamics:** Can promote short-term peace but may lead to resentment.
- **Effectiveness:** Helpful when the issue is more important to one party than the other.
- **Outcome:** Maintains relationships but may compromise innovation and personal satisfaction.